

Alexandra Perkins

Public Policy Graduate Student and Research Fellow | Berkeley, CA

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EDUCATION

Goldman School of Public Policy

Aug 2025 – May 2028

Master of Public Policy

- Recipient of the Goldman School Samuel C. May Fellowship.

University of California, Berkeley

Aug 2017 – Dec 2020

B.A., Anthropology

- **Honors:** Summa cum laude, Phi Beta Kappa
- **Thesis:** Analysis of housing development and environmental review in Richmond, California, advised by Professors William White and Laurie Wilkie.

RESEARCH & WORK EXPERIENCE

California Policy Lab

Aug 2026 – Present

Graduate Research Fellow

- Designed a Python data-normalization pipeline to integrate four disparate sources (loans, tax assessments, valuation, and distress) into a single mortgage-financing dataset, supporting exploratory research on how wildfires shape residential mobility.

Fisher Center for Real Estate and Urban Economics

Nov 2024 – June 2026

Research Data Analyst

- Combined three data sources to create a novel mortgage financing dataset by associating loan performance with residential addresses using a stable marriage algorithm coded in Python.
- Analyzed spatial patterns in wildfire insurance related to socioeconomic status, risk exposure, and premium costs using Python; contributed related figures to a Brookings working paper.
- Evaluated the market for roof replacement financing by matching county parcel data to mortgage financing data, fire risk data, wildland urban interface location data, and inferred roof building materials using Python.
- Periodized a model of building value optimization via energy efficiency investments pursuant to New York's energy efficiency incentive law using Excel and Python.

InsightM (acquired by Zeitview)

May 2021 – Nov 2024

Research Data Analyst Team Lead

- Analyzed 4+ years of remote sensing data on 300,000+ methane emission observations across the US and Latin America.
- Identified high-risk infrastructure by using Python to correlate property-specific characteristics with uncontrolled methane releases.
- Applied regression analysis in Python to reduce the number of false positive detections of methane leaks in low-resolution, noisy infrared data.
- Led the data analysis team for the first comprehensive basin-wide analysis of methane emissions, published in Nature; managed two direct reports.
- Prepared comparative analysis of U.S. and Latin American methane emissions regulations.

UC Berkeley – Museum of Vertebrate Zoology

Aug 2018 – May 2021

Research Assistant

- Utilized a principal component analysis to determine environmental variables most related to reptile speciation.
- Designed and prepared visualizations and maps for publication using R and QGIS.

Milliman

Jun 2020 – Aug 2020

GIS Analyst Intern

- Performed spatial regressions in STATA to inform flood risk models for FEMA's National Flood Insurance Program.

SKILLS

- **Programming:** Python (pandas, NumPy, GeoPandas), SQL, R, STATA
- **Software & Databases:** ArcGIS Pro, PostgreSQL, Git, Jupyter Notebook
- **Methods:** Regression analysis, spatial analysis, data visualization, record linkage
- **Coursework:** Statistical Computing in R, Foundations of Data Science, Calculus, CS 10

HONORS & AWARDS

2019	Undergraduate Research Apprenticeship Program Summer Research Stipend
2020	High Distinction in General Scholarship
2020	High Honors in Anthropology
2017 – 2020	Dean's List, University of California, Berkeley (all semesters)
2026	Goldman School of Public Policy Samuel C. May Fellowship

RESEARCH AND TEACHING INTERESTS

Household finance – Rural housing policy – Inequality and geography – Insurance – Affordability

PUBLICATIONS

Parham, J.F., M.S. Koo, W.B. Simison, A. Perkins, T.J. Papenfuss, E.N. Tennant. Conservation assessment of the California Legless Lizard (*Anniella*). California Department of Fish and Wildlife Grant Agreement Number: F15AF00458 (G1598091), 30 pp.